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GERALDINE DE HAAS 1935-2026

‘THE FIRST LADY OF CHICAGO JAZZ’

By Rick Kogan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

She was a woman former Tribune critic Howard Reich called “the first lady of Chicago jazz,” and for decades Geraldine de Haas delighted in that role. She earned it too, through stunning performances and as a passionate promoter and producer of jazz programs and events that changed the cultural face of the city.

De Haas died the morning of July 28 in Englewood Health Hospital in New Jersey, where she had moved in 2013. She had lost her husband, bassist Eddie de Haas, in 2022; both had been living for some years at the Actors Fund Home, an assisted-living facility also in Englewood.

She was 91 years old and died of natural causes. At her bedside were her Chicago-born children, Darius and Aisha de Haas, both of them, not surprisingly, accomplished singers and actors.

“I have never known anyone more singu-

Dedication to music changed cultural face of the city



TRIBUNE ARCHIVE

lar, dynamic, powerful, generous, hard-working, influential, inspirational and more loving than my mother,” Darius said. “She was also a great wife, artist, community leader, producer and advocate for the arts and notably for jazz, America’s original art form. Through all those things, traversing many worlds and enduring great challenges, she displayed a beautiful humanity which touched so many and will live on. I am unspeakably heartbroken at her loss but infinitely thankful for the gift of being her son.”

Of the memories that began to flow in the wake of de Haas’ death, few were livelier than those from more than a decade ago, a 2013 night at the Jazz Showcase, a good-bye party for Eddie and Geraldine, who were moving to New Jersey to be close to their children.

As Reich reported at the time, “It was a combination jam session, farewell party

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AG pick Blanche clears hurdle

Key Republicans on panel flip vote to advance Trump’s ex-personal attorney for job

By Alanna Durkin Richer and Mary Clare Jalonick
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — Acting Attorney General Todd Blanche cleared a critical hurdle Tuesday in his bid to be confirmed to the post after swaying Republican holdouts on a Senate committee to advance his nomination for a floor vote.

The Senate Judiciary Committee voted 12-10 along party lines in support of the nomination of President Donald Trump’s former personal attorney, who has aggressively pushed the Republican administration’s priorities since taking over from Pam Bondi in April.

The vote followed a deal struck late Sunday between Blanche and two Republican senators — John Cornyn of Texas and Thom Tillis of North Carolina — who had been threatening to block his confirmation over the settlement of Trump’s lawsuit against the Internal Revenue Service regarding the president’s leaked tax returns.

The full Senate could vote later this week on Blanche’s nomination. If all Democrats oppose him, Blanche can afford to lose only two Republican votes if Sen. Mitch McConnell of Kentucky, who was hospitalized after a fall, does not return before then.

Cornyn and Tillis backed Blanche’s nomination after the Justice Department confirmed in writing that it wasn’t moving forward with a \$1.8 billion fund to compensate Trump allies who believe they were prosecuted for political purposes, which the administration announced as part of the settlement.

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INSIDE

Former CPS executive charged with loan fraud

The former top operations chief for Chicago Public Schools has been charged in an indictment with COVID-19 fraud alleging she lied about income generated by a side business to obtain more than \$25,000 in pandemic-related loans. **Chicagoland, Page A2**



JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Let’s see your aim face

Acaya Delgado, 6, gets an archery lesson from Chicago police Officer Jorge Muñoz during a National Night Out event at Columbus Park in Chicago’s Austin neighborhood on Tuesday. The annual event, which started nationally in the 1980s, attempts to promote strong police-community partnerships through outreach and camaraderie. In Illinois, 117 municipalities took part this year.

Mayor praises ‘maturation’ of speaker amid Benton fallout

By Rick Pearson
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson praised on Tuesday the “maturation” of Illinois House Speaker Emanuel “Chris” Welch, whose handling of sexual harassment issues involving former state Rep. Harry Benton has made him politically vulnerable in leading the supermajority House Democratic Caucus in Springfield.

“Watching his maturation has been just a remarkable testament to what’s possible in this country, to serve as first Black Speaker of the House,” Johnson said of Welch when pressed by reporters about the controversy during a news conference. “I trust that the speaker is going to do what’s right for his constituents and the state of Illinois.”

Johnson’s comments came just days after Welch told the mayor’s allies at the Chicago Teachers Union that he would

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As budget chief leaves, Johnson insists city has ‘stability in me’

By Alice Yin and A.D. Quig
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson’s budget director’s resignation is the latest shakeup of his administration’s finance team ahead of what is sure to be a grueling budget season.

Annette Guzman, director of the Office of Budget and Management, left her post to care for her sick mother, the mayor said during a Tuesday City Hall news conference. Her exit, reported by the Tribune Monday night, follows the resignations last week of acting Chief Financial Officer Steve Mahr and Deputy CFO Noor Shaikh in June — which came after CFO Jill Jaworski departed at the beginning of this year.

Johnson on Tuesday tried to tamp down concerns about what the turnover means for the city’s direction by arguing the most important constant is that he has stayed the course.

“They have stability. They have stability in me,” Johnson told reporters. “We do have continuity. I’m the continuity, right?”



Mayor Brandon Johnson speaks to Chicago Budget Director Annette Guzman during a roundtable at Truman College in Chicago’s Uptown neighborhood on June 28, 2025.

EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Again, it’s not just one person in one particular position. I hire people, bring people in who can carry out my mission and vision. There will be others who can carry out that mission and vision.”

The mayor also condemned a question on how the revolving door under his administration affects relationships with aldermen as “reckless and irresponsible” given

that Guzman had a family emergency. But her resignation does leave two of the three top city finance posts without a permanent leader, just weeks before Johnson introduces his fourth budget.

Nonetheless, Johnson said his team remains prepared to introduce a 2027

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